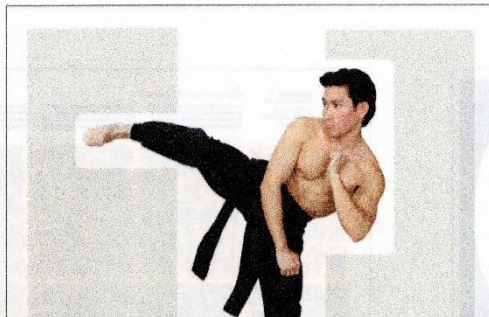


Special effects



There was a time, not too long ago, when all newspaper pages looked serious. Respectable. Gray. Paper was white, ink was black, and everything was locked into rigid gray rows.

Today, that's all changed. Newspapers are livelier than ever. Headlines are red, backgrounds are neon blue and photos run in eye-poppingly true colors. Feature pages look flashy. News pages look flashy. Even *business* pages look flashy. Go figure.

The best designers now pack big bags of graphic tricks. That's partly to make stories more informative, partly to make pages more lively, but mostly to keep up with a world in which *everything* competes for our attention.

Thanks to innovations in computer graphics, design standards keep rising for all informational media. Just watch the news on TV, read some "serious" newsmagazines like *Time* or *Newsweek*, or surf the slickest websites. Their presentation is lively; their graphics are zoomy. So if your newspaper insists on being serious, respectable and gray—locking everything into rigid gray rows—you're falling behind the times. You may even be falling *asleep* (along with your readers).

In this chapter, we'll explore graphic techniques that give pages extra energy. These techniques are optional, but with the right combination of taste and technique, special effects like these can find a home on every page in the paper.

CHAPTER CONTENTS

► Bending the rules:

How some pages go beyond the ordinary to hit new heights..... 196

► The Stewart variations:

Take one photo. One story. One empty page. What are your options for designing a winner?198

► Wraparounds & skews:

Alternatives to standard text blocks, with guidelines on their use... 202

► Photo cutouts:

How to poke body parts out of photos—or simply run entire images against the white page...204

► Mortises & insets:

How to handle overlapping blocks of text or visuals..... 205

► Screens & reverses:

What's black and white and gray all over? How screen tints give pages a whole new hue206

► Display headlines:

A look at type trickery that can turn your feature headlines into something dramatic, flashy and splashy.....208

► Display headline guidelines:

How to use display headlines effectively210

► Color:

Types of color and how the color printing process works212

► Adding color to a page:

How to plan for color214

► Color guidelines:

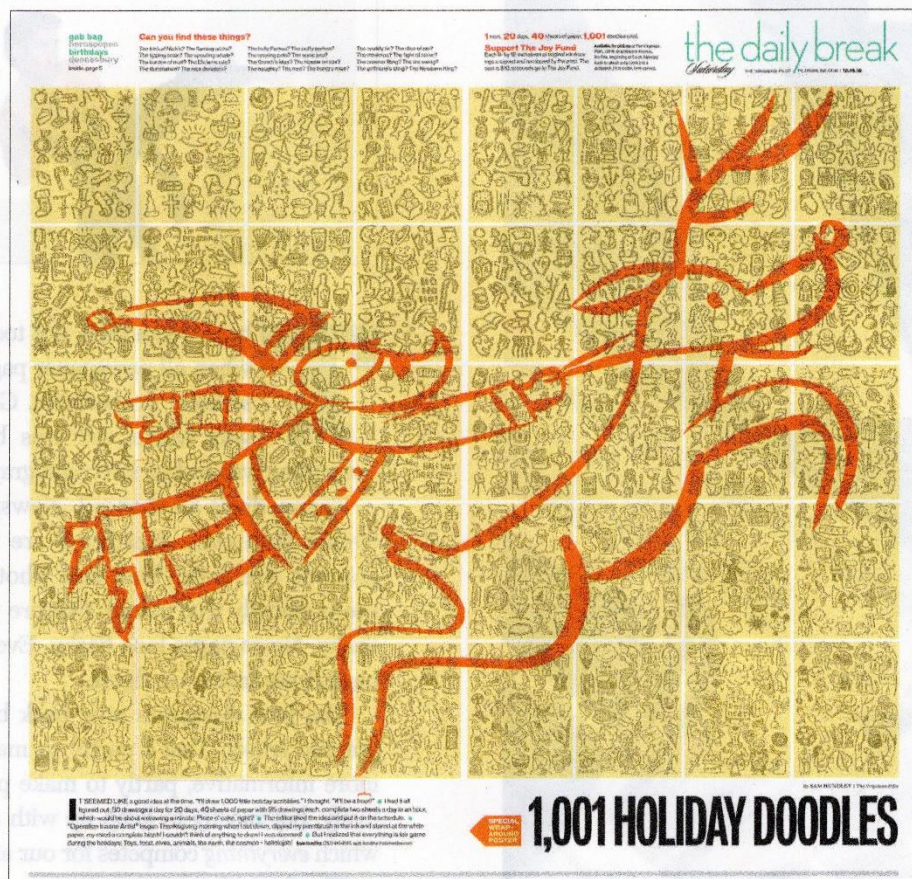
When color will work and when it won't216

► Printing full color:

The process of printing in color218

As you have seen, every paper needs clear and consistent rules for its design. But every so often, by bending those rules, you can produce some stylish pages like these. Just how far are you willing to go? Take a closer look at these pages on this spread. Breaking away from newspaper design conventions is what these pages are all about. Just how far, though, can we deviate from “the rules” before it appears that we have no idea what we’re doing?

Bending the rules

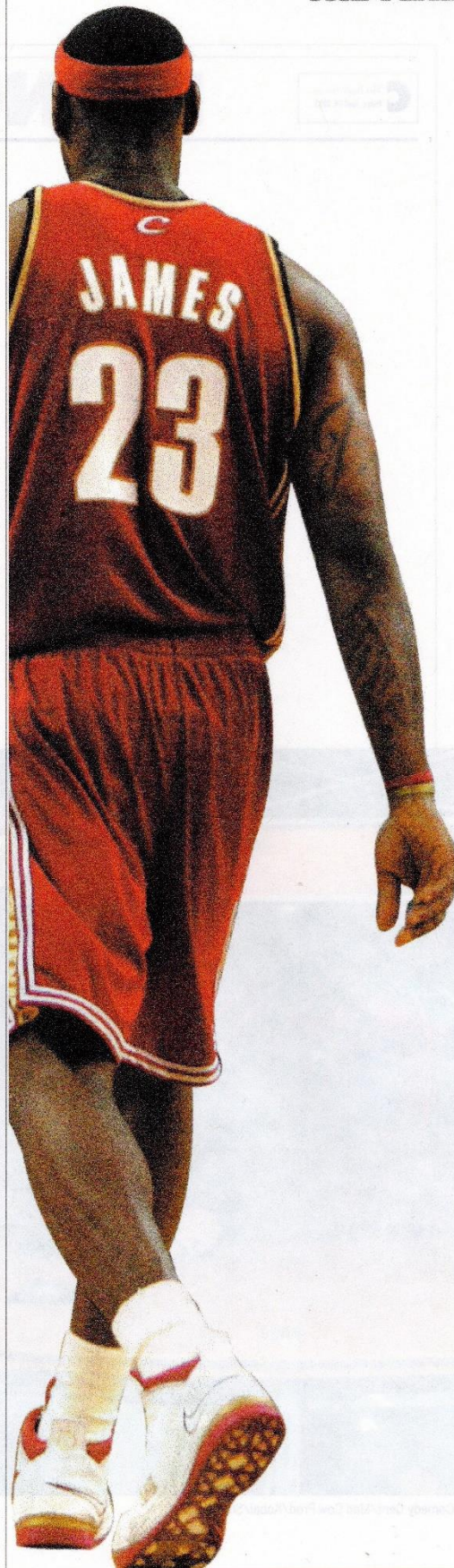


Tough to illustrate How does one visualize the difficult topic of racism accusations within a community? That's what Paul Wallen Jr. asked himself as he brainstormed how to design this front page. Since the story revolves around conversations on the issue, he gravitated toward the oversized “R” and wrote the headline so it was directed toward the reader.

Go big, or go home Sam Hundley, a special projects designer at The Virginian-Pilot, explains the method behind this madness: “My idiotic lark of the 2010 Christmas season: draw 1,001 doodles and design a spread around it. Forty 9X12-inch sheets with 25 ink drawings on each one makes an even 1,000. I planned on taking 20 days to complete this: that’s 50 drawings (two sheets) a day, but I finished in 17 days.” These two pages wrapped around the front and back sections of the features section of the newspaper.

Many designers—one newspaper. A newspaper looks consistent on a day-to-day basis because designers stick by the general rules of a stylebook—with typography, color, grids, etc. There are some days, though, when designers decide to break the rules and create something different that will make readers pay more attention, smile more, interact more. But you have to choose those over-the-top days with a journalistic eye, and remember that the content always drives the design.

Gone.



7 years
in Cleveland.
No rings.

Go big, or go home It was big news in Cleveland—huge news, in fact—when LeBron James decided to leave the Cavaliers and play for the Miami Heat. The Plain Dealer's Design and Graphics Director Michael Tribble and Deputy Design Director for News Emmet Smith put their heads together to come up with this simple concept of James exiting the page—with the sparse, and literal, headline of "Gone." The small words pointing to James' finger read, in almost a whisper: "7 years in Cleveland. No rings." Pulitzer Prize winner Gene Weingarten of The Washington Post called this page "one of the greatest front pages in the history of newspapers." It's on these big news days where doing something drastically different can really work.

The Stewart variations

Newspaper design is a creative craft. And that's especially true on feature pages, where you start with the basic rules of page layout, then nudge and stretch them as far as your time, imagination and sense of taste will allow.

For instance, here's a design exercise on the next few pages that demonstrates the range of options designers can choose from. Suppose you're a designer for this daily Living page. Today's cover will be entirely devoted to one celebrity story, which means you have a lot of space to fill.

Our story is a profile of comedian Jon Stewart, host of the popular TV show "The Daily Show With Jon Stewart." It's a long piece, so you can jump as much text as you like. But there's only one publicity photo available (below, right).

So how will you crop this photo? Arrange the text? Write and display the headline? Take a few minutes to sketch out a solution on your own. After you've done that, take a closer look at 12 Stewart variations over the next few pages.

CAST YOUR VOTE

After studying these dozen Stewart variations, think about what's working and what's not on each page. Which one do you prefer? To help you analyze each option, we've included a scorecard like the one below. Examine each page, then write the grades that seem appropriate.

YOUR OPINION

Headline **B**
 Photo treatment **C+**
 Style & flair **A-**
 Overall appeal **B**



Panic The blank page is one of the scariest things a designer faces. Learn how one designer works through his initial fears of getting past this on Page 91.

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal

[illegible]

Headline

Photo treatment

Style & flair

Overall appeal

[illegible]

Headline

Photo treatment

Style & flair

Overall appeal

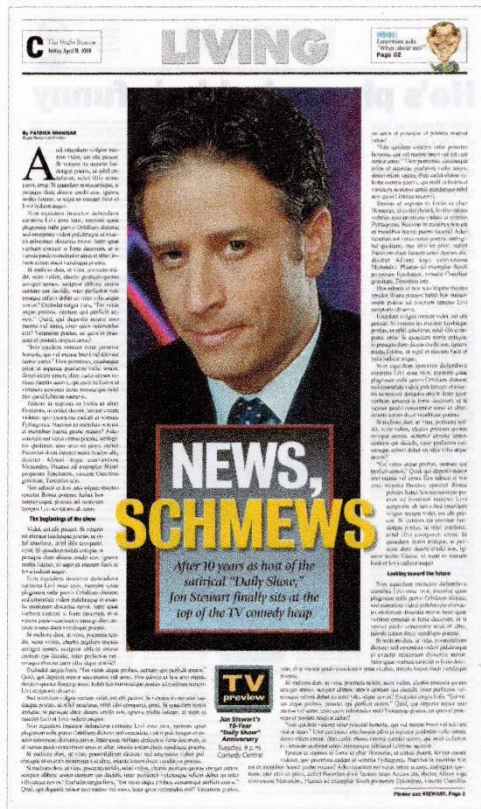
The Stewart variations

5

Here we've moved the headline down, boxing it into the "dead space" in Stewart's chest. Or is there such a thing as dead space in a photo? (Many photographers and editors would argue that there isn't.) Notice, too, how the text stairsteps down the page as it wraps. Is that awkward? And does the text become too wide at the bottom—or is that OK to do for just a few lines?

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal



6

Placing a headline so far down the page may not work on Page One—but it is OK here? Will it be clear to readers that they should begin reading at the top of the left-hand leg? (That's one good reason to start the story with an initial cap.) Notice, too, that we've cut out the top of Stewart's head. Is that an acceptable treatment for a feature photo? If so, can we cut him out even more?

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal

7

In the previous example, we cut out part of Stewart's head. Now we've cut him out completely. Is that permissible? And how about moving him to the bottom of the page? That can be risky. When you park a big photo below the text, it often looks like an ad or intrudes into other stories. But here, with Stewart's head poking into the text, it anchors the page pretty well.

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal



8

We've tried a few new tricks here: First and foremost, we've carefully cropped and positioned the photo so we'll have room to reverse the headline out of that dark background beside Stewart. Down below, we've placed a box on the photo and inserted text there. Notice how the stylish headline treatment makes this package seem more like something you'd see in a magazine.

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal

9

Let's get conceptual. Since Stewart was celebrating his 10th anniversary when this story came out, why not make more of the number 10? Here, we've built it into the headline AND the sidebars. The first sidebar is a collection of jokes. The second is a guide to Stewart's books and videos. It's always wise to provide readers with useful tools as often as you can.

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal

10 YEARS OF YUKS

Jon Stewart celebrates his first decade as the popular anchor for the fake news on "The Daily Show"

CLASSIC STEWART QUOTES

STEWART COMIC COMMODITIES

BOOKS, MOVIES & DVDS

10

Good night and good yuks

Jon Stewart celebrates 10 years as popular host of "The Daily Show"

TV preview

An Stewart's 10 Year Anniversary

The language of the show

10

How far are you willing to push those Photoshop effects? We'd argue that Stewart is a comedian—so it's appropriate to bend the rules a bit. But is the headline type too corny? Is the Stewart-popping-out-of-the-TV too wacky? It's a risky design, but one with a more aggressive attitude. And your ultimate goal, remember, is to grab readers and lure them into the story.

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal

11

Here's another design that relies upon a conceptual graphic effect, and it all starts with the word SLANT. Slanting the page is a comic effect—just as Stewart slants the news for comic effect. That's the best argument you could make to convince a reluctant editor to use this treatment: The design is driven by the story's content. It's not just a nutty layout.

YOUR OPINION

Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal

NEWS WITH A SATIRICAL SLANT

After 10 years as host of "The Daily Show," Jon Stewart sits squarely atop the TV comedy heap

TV preview

An Stewart's 10 Year Anniversary

That's the beauty of our show. Comedy or politics. We're sort of a mix. A space-age polymer of both. A synthetic comedy-like material.

12

AMERICA'S ANCHOR

After 10 years as host of the satirical "Daily Show," Jon Stewart finally sits at the top of the comedy heap

TV preview

An Stewart's 10 Year Anniversary

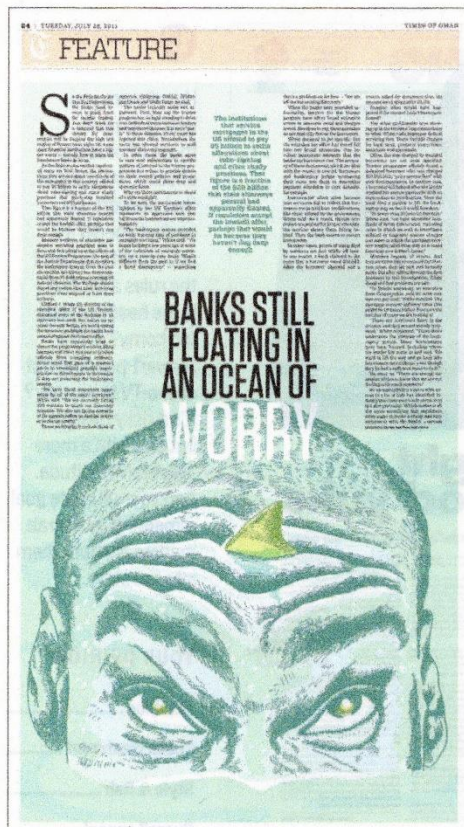
That's the beauty of our show. Comedy or politics. We're sort of a mix. A space-age polymer of both. A synthetic comedy-like material.

12

Here's another treatment that's driven by the story's content. Loyal Jon Stewart fans know he's passionately patriotic even though he's fiercely anti-establishment. (And this aggressive red, white and blue flag-themed design mimics the parodic style he used in his book "America.") But compared to the previous examples, there's not as much text on this page. Is that a problem?

YOUR OPINION

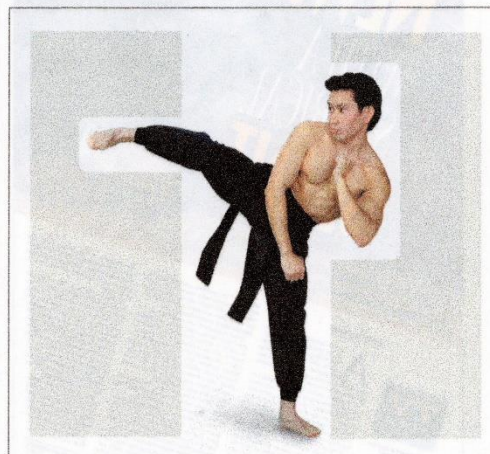
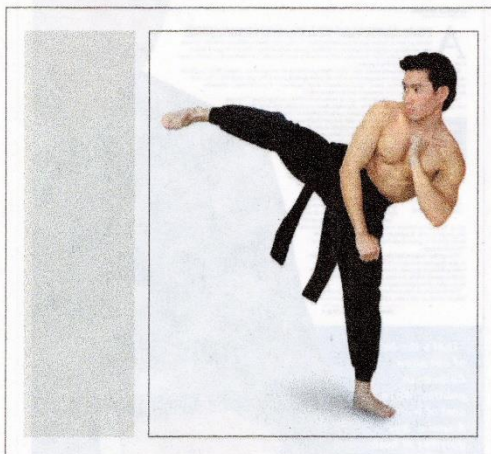
Headline
Photo treatment
Style & flair
Overall appeal



Sort-of wrap Snaking a lot of text around an image can sometimes affect readability. So, instead of creating a straight-up wraparound, look at other options, like we see in the page above. The text here is still modular, but the different leg lengths give it a wraparound feel. The main headline at the bottom of the two middle columns fills the space in an effective way.

Squared off

In the layout at right, we've cropped to the edge of the photo frame. But unless we crop into the fighter's leg (which wouldn't be a wise move, in this case), we're forced to create a layout that's mostly empty white space (since the background is just that ... mostly empty white space.)



More organic

This layout at left, however, fits two legs of type where only one fit before. How? By treating the photo as a cutout, poking both sides of it into the text. Body copy has now filled in the space where there was once white space (that didn't add to the photo's content).

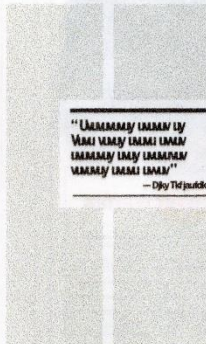
As we've previously seen—both in the Stewart variations and in the swipeable feature formats in Chapter 2—text isn't always locked into rigid gray rows. It can, instead, dodge around liftout quotes, flow around photos and indent around logos and bugs. When a column of text does that, it's called a *wraparound*. (Some papers call it a *runaround*. And when it snakes along a jagged piece of art, it's often called a *skew*.)

Wraparounds can be used with a variety of graphic elements:

Mugs



Liftout quotes



Headlines



Art or photos



Until a few years ago, wraparounds were common in books and magazines, but not in newspapers. That's because they required a lot of time, patience and tricky typesetting codes. But with the advent of page-layout software, type wraps have become a graphic gimmick that's useful for both feature stories *and*—when used with taste and restraint—hard news.

Wraparounds add flair and flexibility to story designs in four ways:

- ▶ They let you place graphic elements in the middle of a layout without disrupting the flow of the text.
- ▶ They let a story's artwork interact more closely with its words.
- ▶ They give you the option of breaking away from using all rectangular shapes on the page, so everything doesn't look too boxy.
- ▶ Best of all, they allow you to run graphic elements at their optimum sizes, rather than wedging everything into rigid column widths.

As you can see here, wraparounds help you use space more efficiently by letting photos and text interact more tightly:

Wraparounds & skews

◆ When you indent an illustration or photo (or even a pullout) into a column of text, try to run at least three lines of text above and below the indented art (as we do at the top here). If you run less than that, readers may not even see that small amount of text above or below the art (see below).



When a pullout or a pullquote sort of takes over the text next to it (just by its sheer volume), you need to back off a bit. Pull on your editing cap and rev up your chain saw: It's time to edit, edit, edit. If you find that you simply can't shorten what you hope to pull out of a story, then start looking for something else to extract that will work even when standing alone, like this text does here. So ... are you exhausted yet as you slog through this long, obnoxious pullout? Yeah—thought so. We're exhausted just by writing it. Seriously.

a little weird. (See what we mean?)

◆ Allow at least a 1-pica gutter between the edges of the art and the text (as we do here).

◆ In most cases, run text at least 6 picas wide (that's our width right here). With really small text, you might get away with 5 picas wide. Remember, the text has to be readable—that's the bottom line. But also keep in mind how tiring it is to read a deep, skinny totem pole of text (like you see here). Try to keep the amount of thin, indented legs you use to a minimum. Not only are they more difficult to read, they just look

◆ In most cases, run text at least 6 picas wide (that's our width right here). With really small text, you might get away with 5 picas wide. Remember, the text has to be readable—that's the bottom line. But also keep in mind how tiring it is to read a deep, skinny totem pole of text (like you see here). Try to keep the amount of thin, indented legs you use to a minimum. Not only are they more difficult to read, they just look

GUIDELINES FOR WRAPS AND SKEWS

► **Don't overdo it.** Any graphic gimmick will annoy readers if they see it too often, and wraparounds can be very gimmicky. That's why big, dramatic wraps are usually reserved for special centerpiece features.

Think of it this way: The text of a story is a road the reader travels; a wraparound is like a pothole in the road. Steering around one pothole is tolerable, but who wants to drive a road that's *loaded* with potholes?

► **Anchor the text block** as solidly as you can. Then start poking art into it at carefully spaced intervals. As soon as the art starts overwhelming the text, back off. (Take a look at this page. It uses several wraps—but they're shrewdly positioned along this solid column of text.)

In other words, don't let wraps create chaos. Align the text legs solidly on the page grid *first*, then carefully position skews as appealingly as you can.

► **Keep text readable.** Severe indents and sloppy spacing undermine your design (see box at right for details).

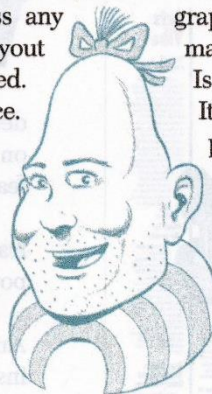
► **Maintain contrast** between the main text block and the object that's poking into it. As you can see here, the sidebar box at right is screened and set off with a drop shadow—and note how the art in the sidebar acts as a buffer between the sidebar text and this main text block.

► **Don't cut out photos** if it damages the image's meaning or integrity. That makes photographers quite angry. (For more on photo cutouts, turn the page.)

► **Smooth out your skews** as much as you can. Abrupt jerks in the width of the text are awkward-looking—and can be awkward to read, too.

► **Choose sides carefully.** As it turns out, skews on the *right* side are preferable to skews on the *left*. Check out the example at the bottom of the page and judge for yourself.

And finally—as we've stressed many times before—try not to force readers to jump back and forth across any simple or ingenious your layout will get confused, lost or annoyed. Take this example, for instance. the designer, that you're sup- then jump across this image of —but most readers will try to get frustrated, then give up. Don't believe it? Go back and as if you're a typical clueless



graphic element. No matter how may seem to you, your readers Is it worth the risk?

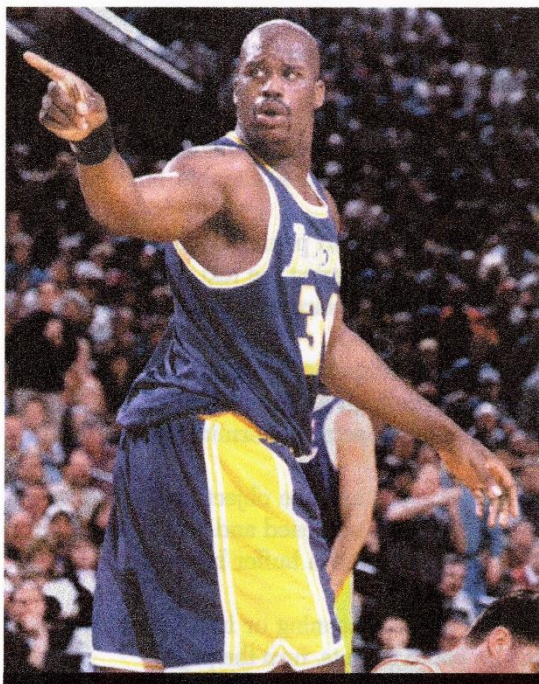
It may seem obvious to me, posed to start reading each line, Zippy the Pinhead to finish it read each column separately, without ever getting this far. read the left leg of text there reader and see how you do.

Here's a block of text with a skew along its *left* edge. It looks appealing, but notice the way your eyeballs keep bouncing back and forth as you finish one line, then search for the beginning of the next one.

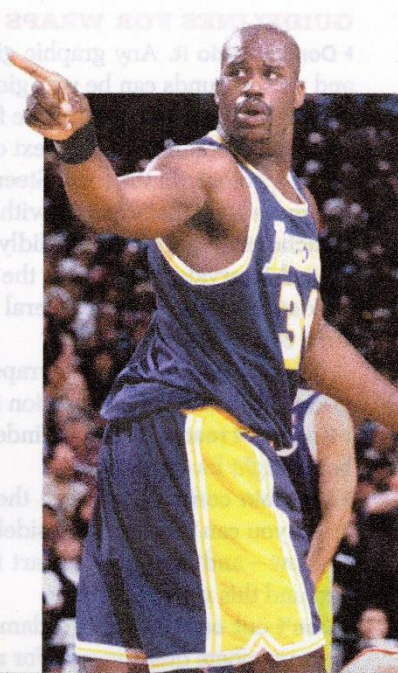
That gets annoying pretty quickly, and it has the potential to turn readers off.

But when text skews along the *right* edge, as it does here, it's not nearly as difficult to read.

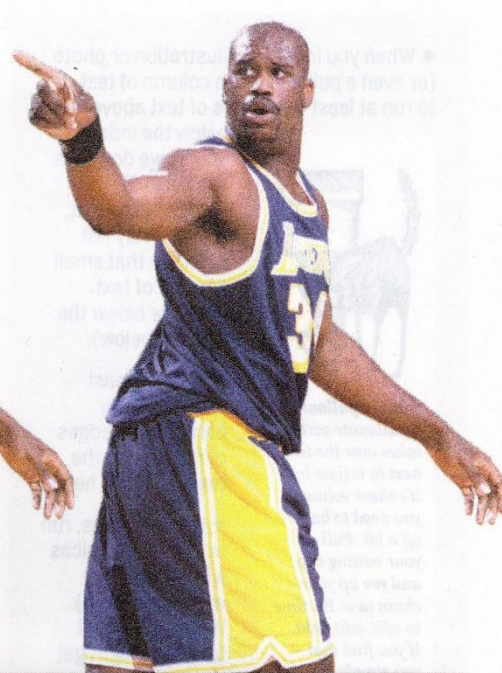
Even though each line ends in a different place, your eye always knows exactly where to go to begin the next line. It's like an exaggerated rag right. Skew on the right if you have a choice.



Standard This basketball photo, with its background intact, is cropped into a rectangle.



Partial cutout In this partial cutout, the player's head and hands poke out of the frame.



Complete cutout Here, the entire background of the photo is dropped out.



Dynamic This tabloid arts page uses a larger cutout at the top of the page as a dramatic lead element and another for its downpage story, too.

We said earlier that photos come in three basic shapes: horizontal, vertical and square. And that's usually true. But occasionally, photos break out of the confines of the rectangle (see the examples, above).

Many photographers and editors loathe this kind of treatment. They argue that it destroys the integrity of the image. (Some even call it "cookie-cutter art.") Designers, on the other hand, consider it a handy technique for creating stylish images for features and promos. They call them *cutouts* or *silhouettes*.

Why create cutouts? It's usually done for dramatic effect. A photo that's boxed and framed seems flat and two-dimensional. A cutout, by contrast, seems almost 3-D. It pops off the page in a fresh, engaging way.

It's also a useful way to eliminate a distracting background from a photograph. And it can tighten up a story design by letting the text hug a photo's central image instead of parking a few inches away.

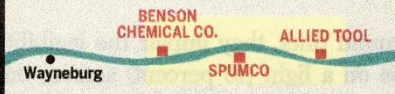
How do you create cutouts? You don't carve up the original photo; instead, you scan the image electronically, then trim it using software like Adobe Photoshop.

When creating cutouts, remember:

- ▶ **Respect the photograph** (and the photographer). A bad crop can change a photo's meaning; a silly silhouette can ruin an image's integrity. So when you can, work *with* the photographer. Discuss your ideas in advance. When in doubt, don't cut it out.
- ▶ **Use cutouts on features**, but decide where you'll draw the line for hard news. What's OK for celebrity photos or fashion shots may be too distracting or disrespectful for news images. Establish clear guidelines so you can avoid arguments when you're on deadline.
- ▶ **Use images with crisp, dark-enough edges.** Light skin and white clothes will fade like ghosts into the background, so be careful. And be especially careful trimming faces, fingers and frizzy hair. Crude cutouts look amateurish.

HUDSON RIVER HOT SPOTS

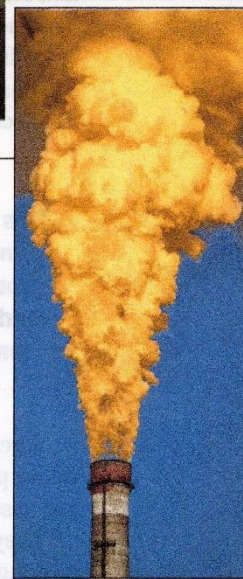
Pollution sites targeted for cleanup by the EPA:



When one text block, illustration or photo overlaps another, it's called a *mortise*. When one image is placed inside another, it's called an *inset*. And here you see four examples of insets and mortises in action: map on photo, photo on photo, photo on text, and text on photo.

When creating a mortise or inset:

- ▶ **Overlap only into dead space**, or to cover up something questionable or distracting. Avoid crowding or covering any crucial detail.
- ▶ **Mortise only photos of different scale**. Always keep readers aware that they're looking at two overlapping elements—not one big, oddly-shaped photo.
- ▶ **Maintain contrast between overlapping elements**: dark onto light, light onto dark. If photos have similar tonal values, add a gutter or shadow around the inset photo, as we've done here.



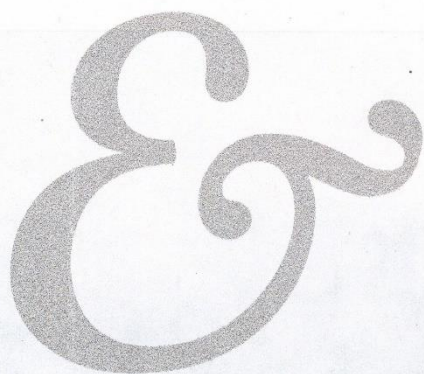
Note: This page remains here despite hysterical protests from some newsroom pros who believe mortises are downright evil. One even wrote us a letter that went like this:

The president board said today that met to the new taxest taxes

His point? You'd never stack one leg of text on top of another, so why would you do it with photos?

Like anything on the page, you've got to judge whether a choice works or not—and steer clear of across-the-board rules about what should—and shouldn't be done.

Screens & reverses



Gray type Screens can be used for printing lighter-colored type. This ampersand is a 30 percent screen of black.



Gray rules Screens can also create gray bars, boxes and borders. The rules above are 50 percent black.



Gray backgrounds Screens can provide background tints behind type. The background here is 70 percent black.

Ink is black. Newsprint is white. So how do we create shades of gray?

We do it by fooling the reader's eye. Instead of using gray inks, we create the illusion of gray by printing row upon row of tiny black dots in a *dot screen*. And the bigger those dots are, the darker the gray is. We've seen how this works in halftones (Page 123), but here's how dot screens create gray tints:



As these examples show, screen densities are measured by percentages. A 50 percent screen will be half-filled with black dots, while a 100 percent screen is solid ink. That ink doesn't have to be just black, either. You can create screens with any color ink, or with any combination of colors—for instance, if you look closely at a color newspaper photo through a magnifying glass, you'll see it's actually a mass of red, yellow, black and blue dots (see Page 213).

When screens are used to create background tints, they impair the legibility of type. It's not too difficult to read black type on a light (10 percent) screen, but as screens get darker, reading gets harder. And it's nearly impossible to read type on dark screens unless the type is *reversed*—that is, printed white instead of black:

This is 10-point type on a white background. It's easy to read, no matter how long the story is.

This is 10-point type on a 10 percent black screen. It's easy to read but works best in small doses.

This is 10-point type reversed on solid (100 percent) black. It's easy to read, but only in small doses.

Screens and reverses dramatically expand the range of contrast on black-and-white pages. Because they're so conspicuous, they call attention to themselves and are best used to accentuate headers, logos, headlines and sidebars.

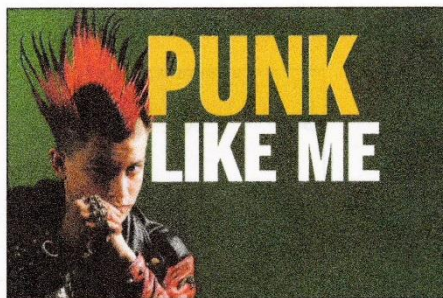
They can also be integrated with photos and illustrations to create a tighter, more striking package, as in this example:



Separate elements In this feature layout, the photo illustration sits above the text and its sidesaddle headline. But there's empty space in the photograph that could be put to use.



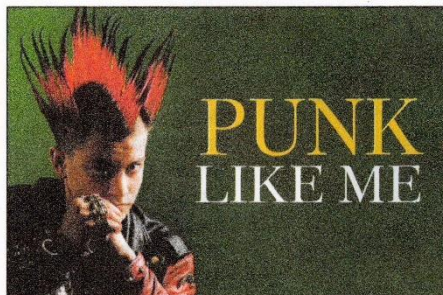
Integrated elements Here, a reversed headline and black deck are placed on the photo. This connects the headline to the image and allows more text to fit in the columns below.



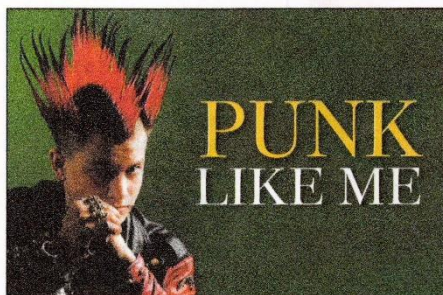
Awkward This reversed headline fits awkwardly into that negative space. It's jammed too tightly against the image—and there's too much dark dead space below it.



Comfortable Here, the words in the headline have been made flush right, giving the image more breathing room around the subject.



Disappearing act The thinner part of the strokes of this typeface have a good chance of disappearing once this is printed on newsprint.



Still risky A thin, heavy shadow behind the headline helps, but the thickness of the letter strokes has remained the same. Use caution, even with shadows.

GUIDELINES FOR USING SCREENS

► **Don't overdo it.** Don't splatter screens and reverses at whim, or your paper will look like a clumsy circus poster. Use special effects *only* to highlight items that are special or different: a feature headline, a column logo, an infographic. Readers often regard these effects as cosmetic decorations, so think twice before screening hard news stories.

► **Don't diminish the readability of text.** Any screen or reverse slows readers down (and should thus be used only in small doses), but some combinations of fonts and screens create obstacles that are impossible to overcome:

Not readable

This is 6-point serif type. On a screen, it's too small. Plus, serif fonts are hard to read when printed against a gray screen like this because the letter strokes can be too thin and disappear.

Sometimes you ask for a light screen, but it prints like this instead. It's too dark—too hard to read.

When type is reversed out of a coarse screen, the screen dots break up the type characters.

Readable

This is an 8-point sans serif font. Sans serif fonts, **especially bold**, are more readable against lighter-color screens.

This is a true 10 percent screen. It's easy on the eyes. With a darker screen, though, you risk losing legibility.

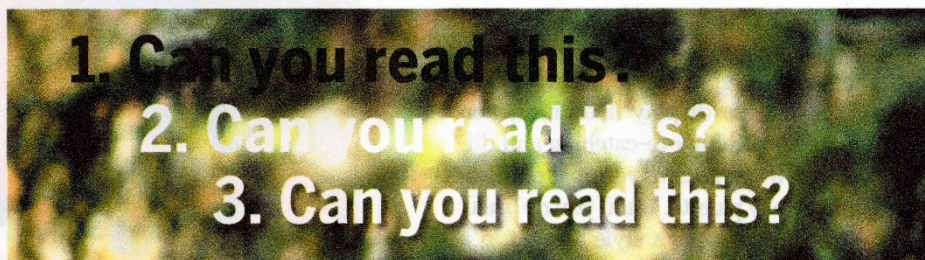
When type is reversed out of solid black, the letters keep their shape. And bolder type is even easier to read.

► **Don't screen small text type**, unless you don't mind if it breaks apart like this.

Gray headlines are OK, but be sure the font is big and bold, since the dot screen may give it a slightly ragged edge.

► **Position the type thoughtfully.** Avoid violating a good photo composition with a crowded (or awkwardly floating) reversed headline or outline. Any added type should complement the central image—not compete with it.

► **Don't print type against distracting backgrounds.** Look at the mottled, inconsistent background in the photo below. In such cases, a *drop shadow* behind the type may improve legibility—but proceed with caution. As a rule, type is legible only when it's dark against light or light against dark.



Readability You can see how a distracting background affects (1) black type, (2) reversed type and (3) reversed type with a black shadow. Try to maintain at least a 50 percent difference in screen value between type and its background, so that the shadow doesn't overpower the type itself.

BODY COPY TIP Reversing body copy, or placing it on a screen, can add variety and impact on a page, but readability can suffer if you're not careful. To be sure the words will read, add extra leading (space between lines) and make the type bolder than you normally would. Also, you might want to try a sans serif typeface instead of a serif one—thin strokes can disappear, especially when the type is reversed.

Display headlines

Ordinary news stories use ordinary headlines. And then there are features, which let you stretch beyond the confines of those routine *Council-mulls-landfill-zoning* headlines. Using type as a tool, you can make a cultural statement. Forge a new visual identity. Or craft a miniature work of art.

Some newspapers allow designers total freedom to create loud, lively headlines. Others insist that display headlines follow the same rules—and use the same typefaces—as the rest of the page (that's to keep feature stories from looking *too* different from the rest of the news).

There are a couple of general guidelines to keep in mind before you plunge too far off the deep end, though:

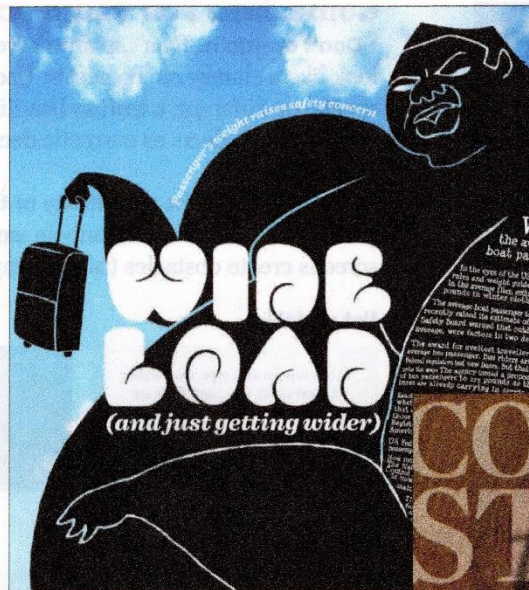
Limit the “tricks.” On many feature pages, especially for the centerpiece, there are opportunities to be innovative with typography—bold type treatments can bring a page to life, as you can see on the pages at right.

But sometimes designers are tempted to pile on the special effects: Why just make a headline bold when you can also ... add a drop shadow, place a glow around the letters, make it all caps, select a screaming red-hot color AND underline the words?

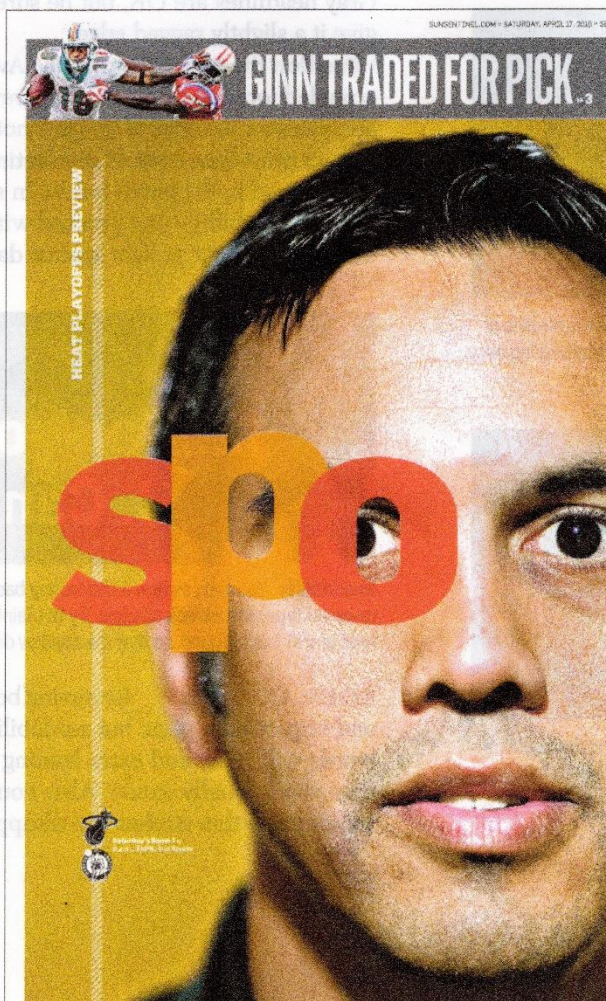
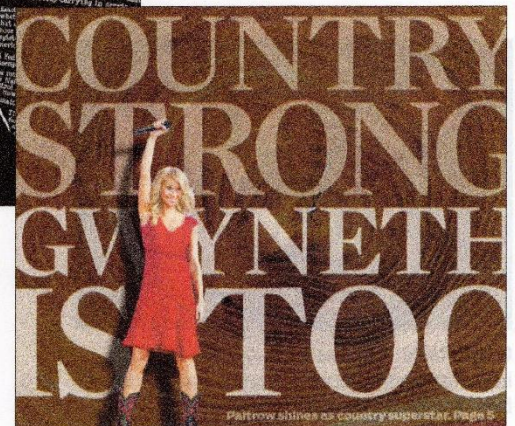
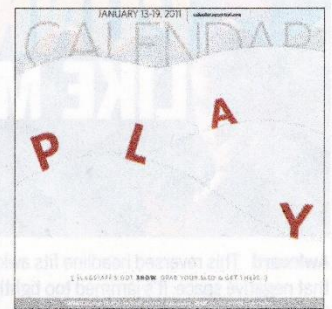
Note that three of the four pages you see here have headlines set in fairly clean, straightforward serif and sans serif typefaces. But also notice how these headlines are used in unique ways. The “Wide Load” headline is more decorative, for sure, but it fits the story's content and becomes part of the illustration around it.

The point here? That when it comes to creating effective display headlines, you *can* create something eye-catching and different, even if you stick to your paper's limited typography palette. But if you *do* break away from your paper's style and go in a more decorative direction, remember that it's usually best to keep all the fancy tricks to a minimum.

Develop good typographical taste. Observation and experience are everything in learning how to use typography effectively. Study every typography resource at your fingertips—and look at as many examples as possible to get a sense of what kinds of headline treatments help advance the story.



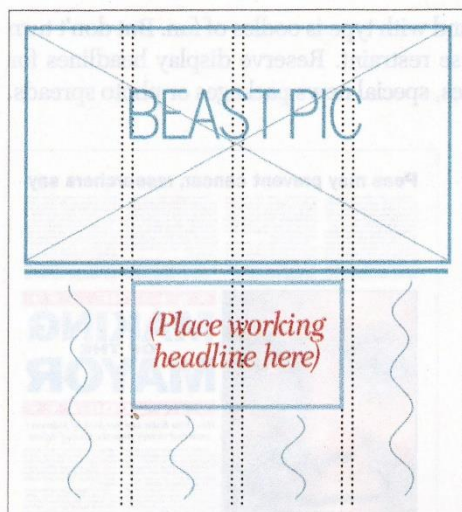
Bold In this story, above, about the issue of passenger weight on airplanes, the Times of Oman used a bloated-looking typeface to get the point across. On the upper right page, The Arizona Republic uses just four all-cap letters in a clean sans serif typeface that are used in a playful way to show snow.



Unexpected In the page above from the Sun-Sentinel, an all-caps serif headline is blown out across the page from top to bottom and becomes a main visual element in this weekly tabloid entertainment cover, which features a story on Gwyneth Paltrow's turn as a country singer.

Unconventional The page on the left shows the main part of a centerpiece about Miami Heat's basketball coach Erik Spoelstra. The Sun-Sentinel used large, brightly colored, sans serif letters to obscure part of the coach's face. Additionally, the eyes, which draw in readers, have a similar feel to the rounded letters.

Display headlines



Wordstorm it! Lots of designers struggle with writing headlines. And not all designers depend on a copy editor to write them, especially when the headline will affect the way a story looks—a centerpiece, for example. One way to break through this writing block is to brainstorm with words only. On a plain sheet of paper, write as many words and phrases as you can think of (and a little help from a thesaurus would help, too), as quickly as you can. Don't think too hard—just write. Free-associate. After you've filled a few pages, step back and see what words come together to best tell the story.

DUMMYING AND BUILDING DISPLAY HEADLINES It can take hours—days—to write the perfect headline for a special story. But while you're waiting for inspiration to strike, you may need to go ahead and dummy that story, leaving what's called a *working headline* in place.

In the dummy at left, the designer left a horizontal space for a headline—which later turned out to be “Beauty and the Beast.” With enough time and energy (and a big bag of fonts to choose from), you could fill that hole with a headline like this:

This typeface, Snell Roundhand, has a **blurry black drop shadow**. The text is set at 69 pt.

An 80-pt. Baskerville italic ampersand has a **light feathering** effect applied to it and overlaps other words.

Beauty
& **the BEAST**

The 48-pt. Interstate Bold typeface has the **bevel and emboss** special effect applied to it. The word “the” is Scotch Regular Italic.

Like many designers, you may have access to dozens of typefaces and to computer software that can crunch, curve and contort type. Fine—but go easy. In the world of typography, keep in mind the rule that bears repeating: *just because you can, doesn't mean you should*. Dial back on the type tricks. Even if you're restricted to just *one* type family, you're not necessarily that limited: you can use screens, rules and boxes to add style, variety and contrast to any headline. The headlines below, for instance, use just the Interstate family. Let's take a closer look at how their components were crafted:*

Beauty
AND THE **Beast**

Simple The two upper- and lowercase big words here (“beauty” and “beast”) are set at the same size (42 pt.) and both are 100 percent black. The smaller words are 10-pt., all caps. This headline is clean and readable.

BEAUTY
AND THE **BEAST**

Overlapping This all-cap headline feels more integrated because the two big words are overlapping. “Beauty and” is 40 percent black; “the beast” is 100 percent black. Do you think the big words are legible?

BEAUTY
AND THE
BEAST

Contrast Using different weight in a headline can help add contrast. Here, “beauty” is set in a Thin weight, while “beast” is set in “Light.” “And the” is Regular weight, and reversed out of a 30 percent screen of black.

Beauty
AND THE
BEAST

Space “Beauty,” at 42 pt. with a 40 percent screen of black, has really loose tracking. “Beast” also has loose tracking. “And the,” which is tilted, is tracked out as well. There is extra air here, but how much is too much?

Beauty
& *the Beast*

Values “Beauty” is reversed and set in an UltraBlack Italic weight at 42 pt. The ampersand is 53-pt. Black Italic. “Beast” is Regular Italic at 42 pt. and 20 percent black, and the reversed “the” is 10-pt. Regular Italic.

BEAUTY
AND THE
BEAST

Tricked out Too many tricks can detract from the page. Here, the type bleeds off the edge of the radial-screen-filled box. The all-caps, reverse big words are set in two different, but similar weights. Does this work?

* Because screens vary from one printer to another, the densities used here may need adjustment at your paper.

Troubleshooting

Q Some art directors say you should never use “gimmicky” headline fonts—that you should never deviate from your paper’s font palette. Is that right?

Never say never. It’s true that you should avoid spraying fonts willy-nilly around your newspaper. (You should also avoid fonts with silly names like Willy-Nilly.) After all, you don’t want your paper looking like a circus poster.

Or do you? Suppose you’re running a feature story on clowns, for instance. Which of these headlines is most appropriate?

**SEND
IN THE
CLOWNS**

**Send in the
CLOWNS**

**SEND IN THE
CLOWNS**

Top: This junky typeface and the garish colors makes this headline look amateurish and garish.

Middle: A headline like this on a feature page could be just fine, or dull, depending on the context.

Bottom: Circus type? This could pull one’s eye away from photos on the page—or it could draw readers in.

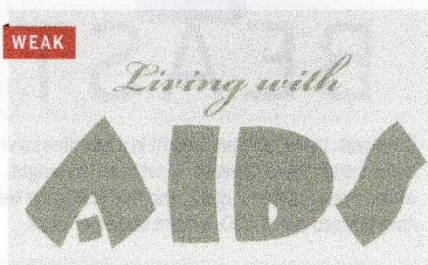
Bottom line: Yes, “gimmicky” fonts can look ugly, sloppy and clichéd. But with the right topic and the right style, moving away from your paper’s type palette can look fresh and appropriate. It boils down to taste and strong design—not which typefaces you use.

Don’t overdo it. Sure, noodling around with type is oodles of fun. But don’t turn your pages into circus posters. Use restraint. Reserve display headlines for special occasions: big feature stories, special news packages or photo spreads.



Too much Sure, it’s a matter of personal taste. But if you park display headlines in every corner of the page, it’ll look like rebel bands of typographers seized control of your newsroom. When you put too much emphasis on decoration, you distract your readers.

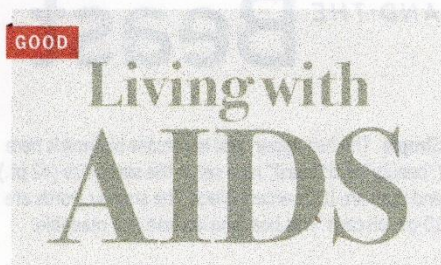
► **Match the tone of the story.** Be sensitive to your topic. Use bold, expressive type when it’s appropriate—but don’t impose it on topics that require more understated, dignified type (below, right).



A disconnect For serious subjects like the one above, it’s not a good idea to use playful typefaces in the headlines.



About right Here, we’ve saved the flashy type for where we need it most: in the lead story and that small feature in the bottom corner. Because the other stories are standard news items, they get standard headlines. This typography helps readers sort the news.



More appropriate The serif typeface like the one above has a more dignified feel to it than what’s at left and is a better choice in this case.

► **Keep it short and punchy.** To give a display headline maximum impact, build it around one or two key words or a clever, catchy phrase. Think of popular movie titles (*Jaws*, *Star Wars*, *Ghostbusters*, *Snakes on a Plane*) and keep your story titles equally tight. Wide, wordy headlines may be fine for hard news stories—

BABY BUNNIES SPREAD EASTER JOY

—but phrases like that may seem heavy or threatening on feature pages.

So play with the story topic to draw out a short, punchy title. Then play with the phrasing to decide where the graphic emphasis should go.

Display headline guidelines

No. No. No. Too many typographical tricks will instantly brand you as an amateur. Check out the common mistakes beginning designers make, below:

Boo!

Novelty type Sorry, but some typographic clichés are hopelessly corny. Silly or gimmicky type can instantly make you look like an amateur.

Designers
GONE
Wild!

Special effects Tilting, tinting, gradient-screening—a little goes a long way. It's fun to do, but it just adds noise and distraction to the page.

SUNDAY
SCHOOL
TODAY

Sharing letters Sharing jumbo letters can be confusing. (SUNDAY CHOOOL?) Beginning and ending a word with enlarged caps too often looks clumsy.

THIS YEAR'S
BEARS
ARE THEY
BETTER
OR JUST
BADDER?

Rules and bars The stacks in this headline go on and on and on. Too many rules, bars and words make headlines dense and stripy.

► **Grid it off.** That's design jargon for aligning your type neatly into the story design. Wild, ragged words that float in a free-form, artsy way just add clutter and noise. And noise annoys readers. Instead, enlarge, reduce, stretch or stack words so they're solidly organized.

WEAK
Singin'
in
the
Rain

GOOD
Singin' in
the Rain
Singin'
in
the Rain

Noncohesive This headline floats too much. It's not anchored. The leading looks awkward and uneven—and worse, none of the words align. It calls too much attention to itself. On a busy page, this headline would just add to the confusion.

Cohesive Each of these headlines is neatly stacked. The top one aligns flush right; the bottom one lines up along both sides. Some words have been resized to ensure a clean fit. Note how in each headline the second line manages to avoid the descender of the "g".

As you manipulate the words, watch for natural breaks in phrasing. Will key words play better wide? Narrow? Centered? Stacked vertically, a headline may work best all caps. And you may want to run a word or line in a different weight or font (be careful, though) for emphasis or variety.

WEAK
the
story
of
life

GOOD
the
story
of
life

GOOD
The
STORY
of
LIFE

Lowercase As you can see in this feature headline, many lowercase characters don't stack well vertically; the contours of the ascenders and descenders leave uneven gaps that are difficult to fill smoothly.

Lowercase with adjustments The words in this headline flow around the uneven ascenders and descenders. Notice how the "i" and the "y" flow together; notice how the dot of the "i" has been replaced by the word "of."

All caps Above, the key words now use all caps to provide more solid, even contours. Unlike lowercase letters, all caps are even along the top and bottom, so you're really working with words that are shaped like rectangles.

► **Go easy on gimmicks.** We've all seen terrific typography on movie posters, beer bottles and CD covers. But those are designed by highly paid professionals. Your darling headlines may look clumsy—or illegible—if you choose goofy fonts, run headlines sideways, create artsy hand-lettering. So beware of gimmicky type. Do you really want readers to think you're a flake?

For decades, newspaper editors stubbornly insisted that color was fine for the Sunday funnies, but news pages should be black and white and read all over. But in the '80s, after USA Today launched, newspapers finally realized that color isn't just decoration; it attracts readers as it performs a variety of design functions:

The flag

This cyan tint makes USA Today's logo immediately recognizable. Each of the paper's section fronts is branded with its own color, too: the Sports header is red, Money is green and Life is purple.

Typography

Notice how color is used to make special type elements pop: the red for Wild-card Weekend along the top, the purple, red and black logo for the centerpiece story. Even those bullets on the Newsline briefs are color-coded to each section of the paper.

Photography

Prior to 1980, photojournalism was primarily a black-and-white craft. But at most modern publications, color photos on section fronts are mandatory. Color reproduction is more difficult and expensive, but that cost is offset by the appeal color photos have and the added information they convey.

Illustrations

Newspapers have been coloring art ever since they started printing the Sunday funnies more than a century ago. On this page, you can see two common uses for color illustrations: creating images for use in graphics (like the woman at right), and producing special logos (the Weekend Edition label above the left rail, for example).

SPORTS SCORES
4 PAGES IN SPORTS
Wild-card Weekend
IN THE USA
Love everything? We talk to Twilight producers. **11 FILMS TO SEE 2011** **LIFE, 1D**

COLLEGE FOOTBALL
Countdown to title game
Auburn says it won't resort to game-slowing tactics against Oregon in BCS title game, 1C
Weekend schedule, 4C

Newsline
Fri/Sat/Sun, January 7-9, 2011
Nelson: A history to sports as life

Gadgets galore at show
Skype expands reach, plans Blu-ray service. Audi shows off 3-D gauges at Consumer Electronics Show, 1, 3B

Gates to cut \$78B from Pentagon
Five-year spending plan includes cutting troops, canceling programs, 4A

Honda says hopes on Civic
New design, to debut at Detroit auto show, comes at pivotal moment, 1B

Storms forecast for East, South
Up to 6 inches of snow expected in NYC; "significant storm" could span South, Southeast, 3A

Blacks less likely to have living wills
Federal study of long-term care patients shows significant gap between blacks and whites, 1A

Obama taps Daley for chief of staff
Pick of Chicago businessman clearest sign that president wants to move toward political center, 4A

Wash. state couple claims lottery prize
"Hearts started flowing" after retiree, wife saw they'd won, holder of Idaho ticket a mystery, 2A

Money: Facebook could go public
Social networking site nears the 500-shareholder threshold that would trigger offering, 1B

Sports: Stanford QB to stay in school
Andrew Luck could be No. 1 pick in NFL draft, but he says he's committed to earning his degree, 1, 5C

Life: Cruise productions amplified
We compare a new generation of ships offering Broadway and Vegas-style entertainment, 4D

Sustained singer relishes stars for peace, 1D
Ten bargain travel destinations for 2011, 4D

USA TODAY Snapshots®
Hours a day Americans in debt worry about money
1-3 hours 63%
4 hours or more 22%
0 hours 15%
Average 3.3

Employment rebound
Average monthly employment by quarter (in millions)
More than 8.3 million jobs were lost during the 2007-09 recession. Economic consulting firm Moody's Analytics forecasts about 3.2 million of those jobs to be recovered by the third quarter of this year.
See the jobs forecast for more than 100 metro areas and all 50 states at jobsforecast.moodys.com

FOR JOBS, SIGNS OF A RECOVERY
Hiring to pick up in 2011, analysts predict
By Paul Davidson and Barbara Hansen USA TODAY

Cover story
AMERICA'S JOBS 2011
Beginning today: A year-long look at the unemployment crisis and prospects for recovery
All three companies say they're feeling confident in the economic recovery and need to add workers to grow. "All six of my business groups are seeing a pickup," Union Pacific CEO Jim Young says. "To me that says there's some legs" to the recovery.
For the first time since the Great Recession began more than three years ago, the job market is expected to show strong gains this year as consumers spend more and businesses ease off their hesitancy to hire. The government's report today on December employment may be a prelude — an expected gain of 150,000 jobs, according to a December survey by the Bureau of Labor Statistics. Through 2011, employers will add 183,000 jobs a month — more than double last year's pace, according to the average forecast of 28 economists surveyed by USA TODAY. Where will the jobs be? Almost everywhere. Every state and 98% of the nation's metro areas are expected to add jobs.

U.S. growth slows, still evied
Developed nations hit by economy, aging issues
By Hana El Nassar and Paul Overberg USA TODAY

Populations
Projected population changes in select nations from 2010 to 2025:
India 22%
Indonesia 16%
USA 13%
Mexico 11%
United Kingdom 10%
France 10%
Brazil 10%
Italy 2%
Russia -1%
Germany -2%
Japan -6%

U.S. split on repeal of health care law
Poll shows GOP has the fuel for rollback
By Susan Page and Kelly Kennedy USA TODAY

WASHINGTON — Americans are closely divided over whether the new Republican-controlled House should vote to repeal the health care law that was enacted just last year, a Gallup Poll finds. But partisans on both sides are united: Republicans solidly back repeal, and Democrats overwhelmingly want to let the law stand.

The survey results help explain why Republican leaders are determined to fight ahead with repeal — House Speaker John Boehner has scheduled a vote for Wednesday — even though the effort is virtually guaranteed to fail in the Senate.

The findings, which show independents almost evenly split, also highlight an opportunity for Democrats to renew efforts to make the case for President Obama's signature legislative achievement.

Forty-six percent of those surveyed Tuesday and Wednesday say they want their representative to vote for repeal. Democrats are expected to support repeal, but by a margin too small to be statistically significant.

Drew Altman, president of the Kaiser Family Foundation, calls the repeal effort "dramatic political signaling" by Republicans that they plan to use the health care issue to keep Tea Party supporters satisfied and their political base united.

The more significant battles will come later, he says. The repeal vote is likely to be followed by months of efforts to chip away some provisions of the law and to deny other provisions the federal funding they need to be implemented.

Republican sponsors say the law will cost the country billions, and they later named their bill the "Repeal the Job-Killing Health Care Law Act."

However, the non-partisan Congressional Budget Office on Thursday concluded that repealing the law would increase the national debt by about \$230 billion from 2012 to 2021.

House Majority Leader Eric Cantor questioned the CBO report. Budget office accountants, though non-partisan, "are only able to score the bill that was put in front of them," he said in a statement.

He said Democrats had used tax increases, " gimmicks that double count savings," and Medicare cuts to fund the law.

Democrats call the repeal vote a "stunt."

"The Republican effort to repeal the health reform law will not pass, and it is little more than a stunt to score points with their base," says Megan Lachapelle, spokeswoman for Senate Majority Leader Harry Reid, D-Nev.

The White House and congressional Democrats are launching a full-court press of speeches, events and press releases to spotlight popular parts of the law that already have gone into effect, such as provisions that allow young adults to stay on their parents' health insurance plans age 26.

Three members of Obama's Cabinet sent a letter to Congress warning that repealing the law would exacerbate the problems it has prompted the law in the first place, including higher premiums for consumers and less competition among insurers.

In the poll, a majority of men endorse repeal while women are inclined to vote to let the law stand.

One of the most dramatic divides is by age. By 50s-60s, young adults under 30 support the law, but their middle-aged parents, those 50-64 years old, favor repeal by an almost equally wide margin.

The poll of 1,025 adults has a margin of error of +/-4 percentage points.

Hours a day Americans in debt worry about money
1-3 hours 63%
4 hours or more 22%
0 hours 15%
Average 3.3

USA TODAY Snapshots®
Hours a day Americans in debt worry about money
1-3 hours 63%
4 hours or more 22%
0 hours 15%
Average 3.3

USA TODAY Snapshots®
Hours a day Americans in debt worry about money
1-3 hours 63%
4 hours or more 22%
0 hours 15%
Average 3.3

Promos and teasers

Front-page promos have two jobs to do: attract attention and guide readers inside. The best way to attract attention, obviously, is to run lively, compelling color images—especially faces of well-known celebrities. Most newspapers dedicate the top portion of Page One to promos using color photos and color type.

Color screens

Adding a screen to the background of a story is an effective way to give it extra emphasis. Notice how the gray screen gives the lead story just a little more visual emphasis.

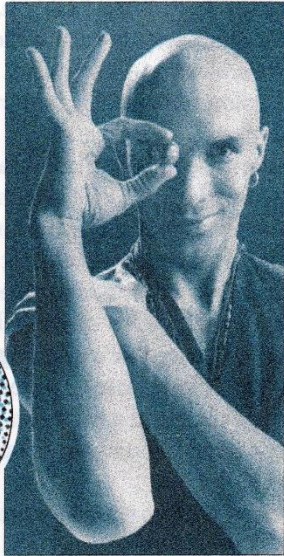
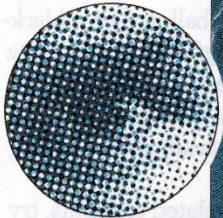
Infographics

Charts, graphs and maps rely on screens and rules to separate elements and enhance readability. And adding color makes them even more effective, as you can see in that centerpiece story about employment. Large-scale color infographics can become the centerpiece of a page, particularly when no photos are available. Small, color infographics (like the population chart) provide essential data, as well.

Advertisements

More and more papers now run color ads on Page One. This particular front page doesn't have an ad, but there's surely one on the back page of this section, since sharing color printing positions with advertisers defrays the newsroom cost of color production.

At right is a duotone, a photo that's reproduced using both black and a spot color. As you can see in the enlargement below, the duotone combines different-sized black and blue screened dots to create the blue-gray effect.



Spot colors Like basic black, these can print as either solid tones or tints. Here, for instance, are some screen percentages for a spot blue:

10%
BLUE30%
BLUE50%
BLUE100%
BLUE

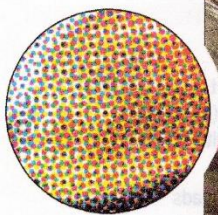
Black You add richness and variety to spot colors by mixing in black:

20%
BLUE+
10%
BLACK100%
BLUE+
30%
BLACK

Pastels These work best for background screens, while solid tones are best for borders and type:

THIS IS 100% BLUE / 20% BLACK
TYPE OVER A 10% BLUE SCREEN
WITH A 100% BLUE BORDER

4-color photo At right is a full color photograph that has been reproduced using all four of the process colors. The image below combines different-sized cyan (blue), magenta (red), yellow and black screened dots to create the effect of full color.



PROCESS OR FULL COLOR But what if you want to print *all* the colors—the whole rainbow? You could add hundreds of separate spot inks, but that would cost a fortune (and you'd need a printing press a mile long). Instead, we can create the effect of full color by mixing these four *process* colors:

CYAN MAGENTA YELLOW BLACK

By layering these four colors in different densities, a printing press can create almost any hue.

Publishing process color costs more—not only for the extra ink, but for the production work that's needed to prepare and print pages. Though desktop-publishing hardware and software have streamlined the process, the end result is still the same: color images must ultimately be separated into those four process colors, then recombined as the presses roll. (See Page 218.)

COLOR TIP Don't use color on jump lines. If you have the opportunity at your paper to make corrections at the end of the night (because your paper puts out more than one edition), chances are that you'll only be able to make changes on the *black* plate. Altering anything on the other, color plates costs extra—and should be avoided.

Process colors These can print as either solid tones or screens. Here, for instance, are the four process colors reproduced as 20 percent screens:

20%
CYAN20%
MAGENTA20%
YELLOW20%
BLACK

Values Combining different values of process colors creates new hues:

50%
CYAN,
50%
YELLOW10% CYAN,
40% MAGENTA,
50% YELLOW

Pastels These work best for background screens, while solid tones are best for borders and type:

50% CYAN / 100% MAGENTA TYPE
OVER A 20% MAGENTA / 30% YELLOW
SCREEN WITH A 100% CYAN BORDER

Adding color to a page

Troubleshooting

Q At our newspaper, we mix colors in an unorganized and inconsistent way. How do we develop a handsome, reliable color palette?

Good color doesn't just happen. It takes careful research and patient testing, *on* newsprint and *on* your press. (Remember, there's a world of difference between the colors you see on your computer monitor and the colors your press actually prints on paper.)

Every newspaper needs an official color guideline. To develop it, it's important to test different hues in things like maps, charts and headlines to find an array of colors that truly complement each other while performing every necessary duty.

To develop a color palette of your own, try this approach:

► **Get out of your office and into the community.** Look at the colors all around you and take note of the buildings, landmarks, geography, foliage, etc. Miami Beach (sun and palm trees) has a *completely* different color feel than, say, Syracuse, N.Y., (very little sun, and, therefore, no palm trees).

► **Get your hands on a Pantone ink book from a printer,** or collect paint chips from your local paint or hardware store to get some ideas.

► **Create a working color palette on your computer.** Start by assigning a "job" to every color. Do you have a range of neutrals (grays and tans, for example), accents (maybe deep reds and oranges), cool and warm colors? Remember, you can use tints of these same colors to add variety and visual layering to your palette.

► **Be sure your paper's color palette choices are part of the stylebook guidelines.** When too many designers are choosing colors on a whim, the newspaper will look inconsistent. Messy. Unprofessional. A less-is-more approach works best.

"We've got spot purple on this page if we want it." Ohhhh, what a dangerous temptation that is. What a quick way to turn a nice newspaper into junk mail. Yes, color can be a blessing—or a curse. It can delight your readers or destroy your design. Using color successfully requires tight deadlines. Quality control. Extra money. Extra planning.

So plan for color. Don't treat it like a surprise gift. And above all:

► **Go easy.** Resist your initial urge to go overboard. Don't splash color around the page just to get your money's worth. Remember, black and white are colors, too—and newspapers have managed to look handsome for centuries without adding extra inks.

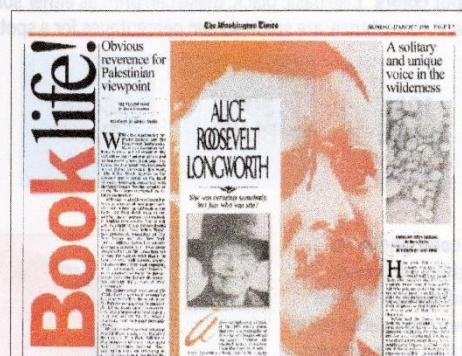
► **Don't use color for color's sake.** Remember, it's a news paper. Not the Sunday funnies. If you're deciding whether to run a color photo of circus balloons or a black-and-white photo of a bank holdup, choose the image that's meaningful—not just pretty.

► **Beware of colorizing false relationships.** Color creates connections, even where none actually exist. Put a *red* headline, a *red* chart and a *red* ad on the same page, and that tint may unite them all in the reader's mind. That can be misleading (depending upon the layout).

Colors speak to each other. So if you don't want to connect unrelated elements, try not to brand them with the same hue.

► **Be consistent.** Don't run a purple flag one day, a green flag the next; blue subheads here, red ones there. Give your pages a consistent graphic identity by standardizing colors wherever they're appropriate. Use the chart below to plan ahead.

Limited palette This feature page at right from The Washington Times demonstrates that color doesn't need to be excessive to be effective. The designer, working with a limited color palette, has carefully balanced the color elements on this page.



WHERE TO ADD SPOT COLOR

THESE WILL USUALLY WORK IN COLOR:*

- | | | |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------|--|
| ► Illustrations | ► Photos (full-color only) | ► Ads |
| ► Charts, maps and infographics | ► Nameplates | ► Rules, headers and art in classified ads |
| | ► Logos and sigs | |

THESE WILL OFTEN WORK IN COLOR:*

- | | | |
|--|---|--|
| ► Display headlines (for big feature stories) | ► Lift quotes, initial caps (best if used in conjunction with color headlines or color illustrations) | ► Signposts: teasers, headers, indexes, etc. (but avoid competing with similar colors on the page) |
| ► Photo duotones (for special feature stories) | ► Decorative rules/bars | ► Boxed subheads within a feature story |
| ► Boxed stories/sidebars (light screen tints only) | ► Borders around photos | |

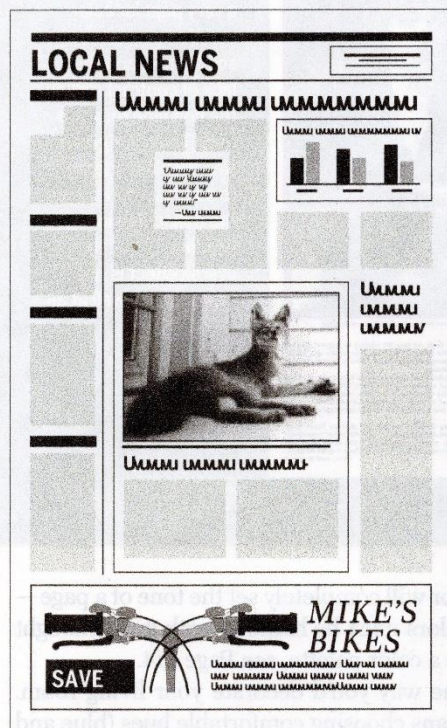
THESE WILL RARELY WORK IN COLOR:*

- | | | |
|--|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ► Photographs (printed with just one spot color) | ► News headlines | ► Boxed or screened hard news stories |
| | ► Text type/cutlines | |

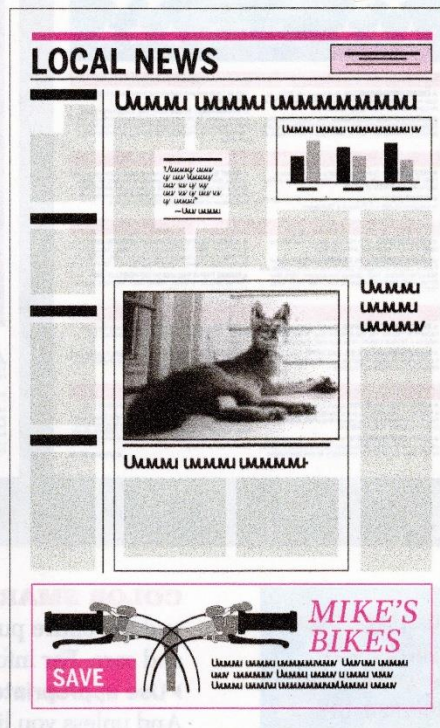
*Depending upon your choice of tint, and whether the color creates misleading relationships between unrelated elements on the page.

Adding color to a page

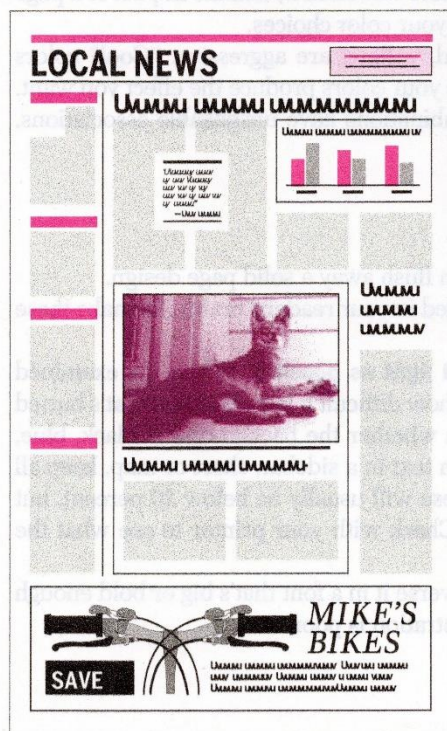
USE RESTRAINT Adding color to a black-and-white page is a tricky thing. Where should it go? How much is too much? For best results, remember that a little goes a long way. It would be unrealistic to dictate where color can or cannot be used—but as these examples show, some choices generally succeed more than others:



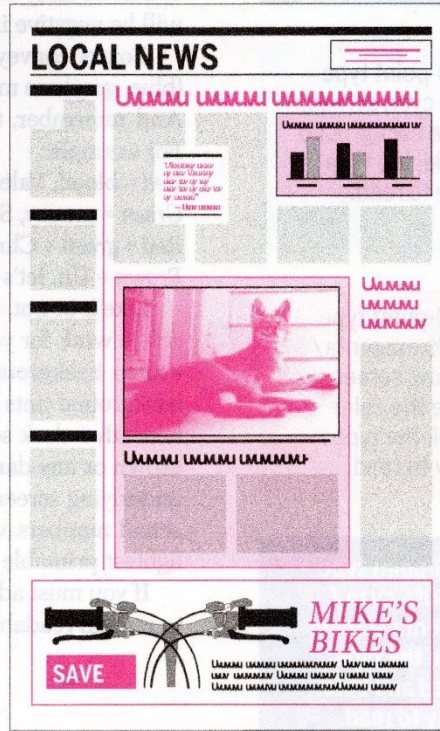
Basic black It may be gray, but it's not dull: By combining a variety of rules, bars and graphic elements, it presents an attractive mix of contrasts. It doesn't need extra decoration; any color we add should probably be functional, not decorative.



Ad colors In the race to add color to this page, the advertiser got there first. And since that red ad is so distinctive and loud, any red we add to the news design may seem related to that ad. That's a problem. To maintain a distinction between news and advertising, you can choose to use a minimum of editorial color. Here, we've applied red only to the header—and we've added 20 percent black to it, to give it a hue that's different from that ad.



Spot color Without color in that ad, we're free to colorize our editorial layout. Still, we've used restraint. We've applied spot color for organization, not just decoration. Red bars in the header and news briefs help anchor the layout; red bars in the bar graph make the information easily discernible. And the lead photo is now a duotone—permissible because it's a feature photo, not hard news.



Gratuitous color We've made some poor choices here—and now the page looks silly. Pink screens taint the credibility of the news. Red headlines and liftout quotes lose integrity. Red rules and boxes distract readers, calling attention to unimportant design elements. And that red photo? It shows how poorly photos print using only process color. The page is weak—and worse, those colorized news elements all seem related, somehow, to Mike's Bikes.

Color guidelines

Patriotic This Fourth of July trivia page on the right was done on the run. The designer had no art, no budget and no time to play. But this clever solution uses only type and few colors to turn a functional layout into a patriotic pattern. The red, white and blue colors instantly communicate the theme of the story.

STAR-SPANGLED BANTER
How big is Oregon's biggest firecracker? Where's the oldest U.S. flag in Portland? For more lore, read on.

THE ROCKETS' RED GLARE
• **HIGHEST FIREWORKS DISPLAY:** Fort Vancouver, Wash. As with all the Portland area, this display goes high—40 minutes, and the fireworks cost \$60,000.
• **OREGON'S BIGGEST FIRECRACKER:** The 100-lb. "The 24 pounder," which went off at 4 a.m. on July 4, 1990, was the largest ever. It was made by the 24th Infantry and the 24th Infantry.

THE HANGOVERS BURSTING BLAIR
• **HIGHEST RAINFALL:** Seven hundredths of an inch July 4, 1989. The average July 4 rainfall for the past 10 years in Portland is two hundredths of an inch.
• **HIGHEST DRY DAY:** August 1, 1972. The all-time average high temperature on July 4 in Portland is 78 degrees.

NOTES ON THE FOURTH OF JULY
• **PORTLAND BIRTH:** 27 in 1888 to Eugene Hospital and Medical Center not the way you might think.
• **PARADE PEOPLE DOWN ON THE FRONT OF JACK:** Ernest Eugene Jackson and Phyllis Ernest Jackson (Mrs. Jackson) and Nelson Van Dusen, 1933. George Washington, 1932. Van Dusen, 1937. G.H. Lusk (Lusk) in 1934. 1938. Nelson Van Dusen, 1931.

LONG MAY IT SWAY
• **HIGHEST U.S. FLAG IN OREGON:** Columbia County, Coast Range. The flag is 100 feet long, 30 feet wide and weighs 10,000 pounds. It was made in 1931 and is now in the collection of the Oregon Historical Society.
• **HIGHEST U.S. FLAG IN OREGON:** The flag is 100 feet long, 30 feet wide and weighs 10,000 pounds. It was made in 1931 and is now in the collection of the Oregon Historical Society.

HOUSES OF THE GRAVE
• **HIGHEST INDEPENDENCE DAY:** Japan. The oldest celebration is a celebration of Independence Day in Portland, Ore. which takes place on July 4, 1990. The oldest celebration is a celebration of Independence Day in Portland, Ore. which takes place on July 4, 1990.

Savings & Moans
A lawsuit alleges a billion-dollar cover-up at Far West Federal

By Eric Deschamps

Lisa Waller says she was wronged for borrowing the money on Far West.

A FIRST BLUSH Lisa Waller seems an unlikely person to sue much of a nation. The 36-year-old woman, who lives with her husband in a San Francisco suburb, is a former nurse and a mother of two. But she has a big fight on her hands. She is suing the Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco for \$1 billion. The lawsuit alleges that the bank covered up a \$1 billion loss in the late 1980s. The loss was caused by a loan to a company called Far West Federal. The company was a subsidiary of the bank. The bank was supposed to be a subsidiary of the Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco. The bank was supposed to be a subsidiary of the Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco. The bank was supposed to be a subsidiary of the Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco.

Cliché This page suffers from poor color choices. Green and purple—not a very popular color combo—are run as solid tones, and the lack of contrast makes the headline tough to read. The color green was probably meant to suggest money (see the dollar sign in the headline?), but the overall effect is not working very well at all.

This is 10-point type over a 100% cyan screen. Because the background tint is so intense, the type is hard to read.

This is 10-point type over a 10% cyan screen. Because the background tint is pale, the type is easy to read.

This is 10-point type over a 10% magenta/15% yellow screen. Because the color is pastel, the type is easy to read.

This is 10-point type over a 60% cyan/60% magenta screen. Because the type is reversed and bold, it's easy to read.

COLOR SMARTS Like typography, color will completely set the tone of a page—and the entire publication. The choice of colors must be handled with great thought and care. For information on how to choose a color palette, see Page 214.

► **Use appropriate colors.** Colorize pages the way you'd decorate your living room. And unless you live in a circus tent, that means choosing comfortable hues (blue and tan, for instance) more often than harsh ones (pinks or bright greens). The integrity of a news story will be damaged if wacky colors surround it, and the impact of a page will be negative if readers are turned off by your color choices.

Colors convey moods. "Hot" colors (red, yellow) are aggressive. "Cool" colors (blue, gray) are more relaxing. So make sure your colors produce the effect you want. And remember, too, that certain color combinations have unshakable associations. For example:

Red = blood, Valentine's Day.

Green = money, St. Patrick's Day.

Red + green = Christmas, Mexico.

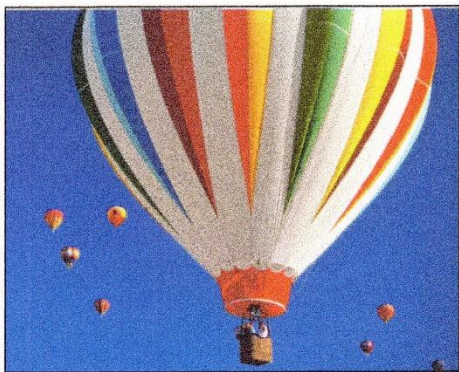
Brown = Uh, let's just say a stinky brown can flush away a solid page design.

Like it or not, these color clichés are lodged in your readers' brains. So make these colors work for you—not against you.

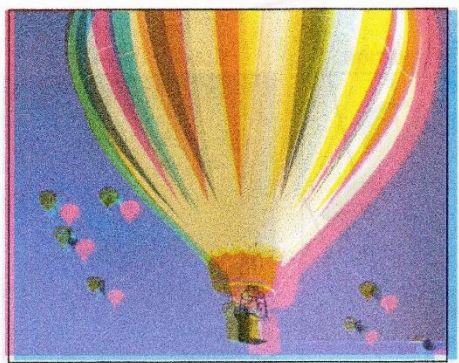
► **Keep background screens as neutral and light as possible.** When we examined background tints back on Page 207, we saw how difficult it is to read text that's buried beneath a dark screen. Well, it's a problem whether the background is black, blue, brown or any dark color. Whenever you run text in a sidebar, chart or map, keep all underlying screens as light as you can. (These will usually be below 20 percent, but actual numbers vary from press to press. Check with your printer to see what the lightest printable percentages are.)

If you must add type to a dark screen, reverse it in a font that's big or bold enough to remain readable even if the printing registration is poor.

Color guidelines



In register This color photo printed correctly. The color inks are properly balanced, so the colors are rich and true. The four color plates are properly aligned, so the image is crisp and well-focused.



Out of register This photo reveals the dangers of poor color production. The inks look washed out and badly balanced. And because the four plates are so far out of alignment, the image looks fuzzy — barely legible. If your color printing looks like this, you're better off using black and white.

		MAGENTA			
CYAN	20% YELLOW	5%	10%	20%	30%
	5%				
	10%				
	20%				
	30%				

Color chart This shows how process inks look when they're combined. This portion of a chart, for instance, shows the tints you get when you add magenta and cyan to 20 percent yellow. The box highlighted above shows the tint that results from mixing 20 percent yellow, 20 percent magenta and 20 percent cyan.

► **Don't overreach your technology.** Color production is difficult to do well. It's costly. It's time-consuming. And in the hands of a sloppy printer, it's extremely disappointing. So it pays to learn your limits.

Illustrations that look gorgeous on a computer monitor often turn to mud on newsprint. Color photos look worse than black-and-whites when the inking is poor or the registration is off (i.e., the color plates print out of alignment, as you see at left).

So use color conservatively until you're certain of the results you'll get. And beware of small, detailed graphics or headlines that demand perfect color registration to succeed—or you'll face legibility problems like this:

THIS HEADLINE REGISTERS THIS HEADLINE DOESN'T

► **Watch the volume level of your colors.** Want your page to look like a Hawaiian shirt? That's what'll happen if you use too many solid tones or too many different colors. So go easy when you colorize. Use bold, vivid colors for accent only, in key locations (drawings, feature headlines, reverse bars). Elsewhere, for contrast, use lighter screens or pastel blends. And if you're designing with full color, try color schemes that accent one or two hues—not the whole rainbow.

Decorative colors are like decorative typefaces. In small doses, they attract; in large doses, they distract.

► **Consult a color chart before you create new colors.** Some papers fail to mix colors and end up running all their color effects in basic blue, red and yellow. As a result, they look like a comics section: loud and unsophisticated. But suppose you want to beef up your blue by adding a little black to it. How much black should you add? Ten percent? Fifty percent? Or suppose you want to mix magenta and yellow to make orange. Should you simply guess at the right recipe—say, 20 percent magenta + 50 percent yellow?

Don't guess. Don't trust what you see on a computer monitor, either—a lot can change between your computer and the pressroom. Instead, ask your printer to give you a color chart (lower left), which shows how every color combination looks when printed. You can even create your own chart—but be sure it's printed on the same paper your newspaper uses, so all your hues are true.

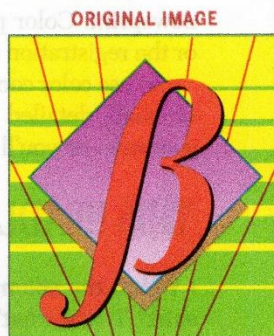


Accent On this page from The Virginian-Pilot, the designer created a playful effect by sketching a magenta mask over the subject's face, then using the same bright color in the main headline. For this entertainment section front, the vivid use of this color works well.

Printing full color

How do you print full-color art and headlines using just four different-color inks? The technology is complex, but the process is simple. Here's how it works for a typical color image:

Step one: The artist draws this color illustration on a computer using an illustration program. As she draws, she creates customized colors in the software's color palette and evaluates the results on her color monitor. (If she's smart, she calibrates her monitor so the colors on her screen match the colors as they will actually print.) When she finishes drawing, she'll transmit this image as a digital file. If this were a drawing on paper, it would need to be separated into process colors by a digital scanner, which uses color filters to digitize the image so it can be printed.



Step two:

The image is output to a high-resolution printer called a typesetter (or imagesetter). The typesetter separates the image into the four process colors, producing film negatives, called "separations," for each color using only black lines and dots.

CYAN SEPARATION



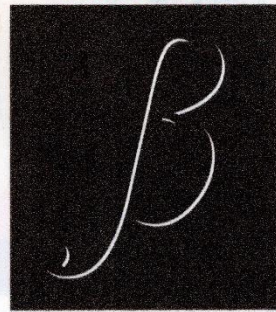
MAGENTA SEPARATION



YELLOW SEPARATION



BLACK SEPARATION



Step three:

Those four different color separations must now be copied again, reproduced onto flat, flexible plates for the printing press—one for each color of ink. When the press starts to roll, each color plate will print the images shown here on the right.

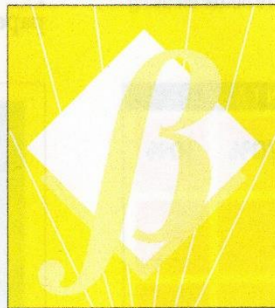
CYAN PLATE



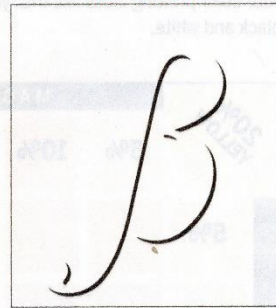
MAGENTA PLATE



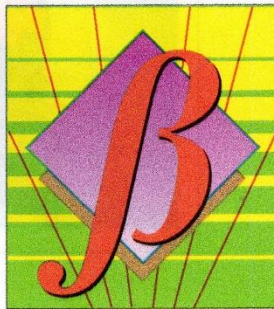
YELLOW PLATE



BLACK PLATE



PRINTED IMAGE



Step four: The presses roll. Newsprint passes across cylinders that, one after another, print each of the four color plates using the four process color inks. If the inks are correctly balanced—and if the newsprint is properly aligned as it passes through the press—then the colors will be accurate and the image will be sharply focused, or "registered." And only examination under a magnifying glass will show how dots of those four process-color inks create the illusion of full color.

Every printer has different standards and techniques for processing color images. That's why, to ensure quality control, you must develop a rapport with your printer and production crew.